

NAVY SECRETARY (1812-73)

STEPHEN RUSSELL MALLORY



When Mallory, a Florida senator, became secretary of the Confederate navy, he had to start from scratch. He assembled a small armored fleet, hoping it might offset the advantages of the U.S. Navy's larger wooden ships. He gambled on winning the war at sea through a combination of raids on Union commerce and the use of ironclads and ingeniously contrived torpedoes.